

3.2.1 Foundation tier

3.2.1.1 Noun phrases

Formation of feminine person nouns

Highly frequent irregulars are listed in the vocabulary list as separate items (eg, *chef/cheffe*, *héros/héroïne*, *Juif/Juive*).

- Add -e
- No change (article changes only)
- -eur → -rice and/or -euse depending on which relevant base words (masculine forms) are included in the vocabulary list
- -en → -nne

Formation of plural nouns

Highly frequent irregulars are listed in the vocabulary list as separate items (eg, *madame/mesdames*, *monsieur/messieurs*, *œil/yeux*).

- Add -s to most nouns
- Add -x to masculine nouns ending in -(e)au and -eu
- No change for nouns ending in -s, -x

Infinitive used as a noun

le, equivalent of -ing (gerund) in English.

Determiners: Articles

Agreement of articles with noun for gender and number (*le, la, les* and *un, une, des*).

Contraction of definite article (*le/la → l'*) before singular nouns that start with a vowel or *h muet*.

Functions of definite and indefinite articles, including where their use or omission differs from English (eg, *La santé est importante, le mercredi*).

Use of definite article before an adjective to form a noun, including uninflected adjectives for languages and addition of a capital letter where the resulting noun is a nationality (eg, *seul → le seul, anglais → l'anglais, anglaise → l'Anglaise*).

Partitive articles when distinguishing between parts and wholes. Eg, after *jouer* with musical instruments, after *faire* with sports.

Use of *de* (and omission of article) before nouns following a verb in negative and after expressions of quantity.

Contraction of *de* to *d'* before a word beginning with a vowel.

Other determiners

Demonstrative adjectives (*ce, cet, cette, ces*).

Possessive adjectives (*mon, ma, mes, ton, ta, tes, son, sa, ses, notre, nos, votre, vos, leur, leurs*).

Interrogative adjectives (*quel, quelle, quels, quelles*).

Agreement patterns for indefinite adjectives (*chaque, plusieurs, même(s), autre(s), tout(e)(s), tous, quelque(s)*).

Pronouns

Subject pronouns (*je, tu, il, elle, on, nous, vous* – as singular and plural formal 'you' – *ils* and *elles* are listed in the vocabulary list. Their grammar (agreement, position) is laid out in this grammar list.

Preverbal position of singular direct object pronouns (*me, te, vous, le, la*) (not juxtaposed with indirect object pronouns).

Preverbal position of singular indirect object pronouns (*me, te, vous, lui*) (not juxtaposed with direct object pronouns).

Preverbal position of singular reflexive pronouns (*me, te, se*).

Contraction of pronouns (*me → m', te → t', le/la → l', se → s'*) before a vowel or *h muet*.

Use of emphatic pronouns *moi* and *toi* after prepositions (the pronouns and relevant individual prepositions are listed separately in the vocabulary list).

Use of relative pronoun *qui* in subject relative clauses.

3.2.1.2 Verb phrases

Verbs and verb forms that do not fit into the grammar detailed here can still be listed in the vocabulary list.

Negation

Syntax of verbal negation with *ne...pas*, *ne...jamais*, *ne...rien* (as equivalent of 'not verb anything' and 'verb nothing'), and *ne...personne* (as equivalent of 'not verb anyone/body' and 'verb nobody').

Interrogatives

Interrogatives expressed through:

- intonation with subject verb (SV) word order, including when followed by a wh-word (*qui, quand, quoi, pourquoi, comment, combien, où*)
- wh-word (*qu', quand, pourquoi, comment, combien, où*) followed by *est-ce que* followed by SV word order
- wh-word (*que/qu', quand, pourquoi, comment, combien, où*) followed by verb subject (VS) word order.

Inflectional morphology

Specific irregular inflected forms (eg, *faites, vont*), as a minimum those specified below, are listed in the vocabulary list.

Some verbs change the spelling in their stems. Eg, accents change (*mener, je mène*), consonants are doubled (*jeter, je jette*), softened (*manger, nous mangeons* and *commencer, nous commençons*) or dropped (*mettre, je mets*). Such spelling changes will not be credit-bearing.

Regular and four very high frequency irregular** patterns in 1st, 2nd, 3rd persons in singular and plural for:*

*-er verbs (eg, *parler*), clusters of high frequency -ir verbs that all pattern following one of these four 'anchor' verbs: *choisir, partir, venir, ouvrir*, clusters of high frequency -re verbs that all pattern following one of these three 'anchor' verbs: *entendre, prendre, traduire*.

***aller, avoir, être, faire* (including use of *avoir* + noun where the English equivalent is 'BE + adjective' eg, + *froid*, + *chaud*, + *an(s)*, + *faim*, + *soif*, + *peur*).

- Present indicative, as equivalent of the English simple (I walk) and ongoing (I am walking) functions, and (with time adverbs) for expression of the future as equivalent of the English simple (the holidays start tomorrow) and continuous (I am working this evening).
 - Irregular inflected forms of the four very high frequency irregular verbs (*aller, avoir, être, faire*) are listed in the vocabulary list.
- Perfect tense, as equivalent of the English simple past (I walked, he went) and present perfect (I have walked, he has gone), including past participle formation for -er verbs and the seven verb clusters listed above.
 - Irregular past participles of three very high frequency irregular verbs (*été, eu, fait*).
- Periphrastic future expression (*aller* + infinitive), as equivalent of the English 'will + verb' and 'BE + going to + verb'.
- Imperative (2nd person singular and plural only, including *aller* and *faire*; but not *avoir, être*; not reflexive).

Regular patterns (see * above) and four very high frequency irregular patterns (see ** above) in 1st, 2nd, 3rd persons in singular only (excluding 'you' formal) for:

- Imperfect for habitual (only for equivalent of English 'used to + verb') and ongoing (BE + ing) functions.
- Irregular inflected forms of three very high frequency irregular verbs (*avais, avait; étais, était; faisais, faisait*) are listed in the vocabulary list.
- Additional English equivalent functions are listed in the vocabulary list as follows: *étais, était* (to mean 'was, were + adjectival complement'), *avais, avait* (to mean 'had').

Other irregular inflected forms

Present indicative forms for 1st, 2nd, 3rd persons, in singular only, of nine high frequency verbs (*boire, connaître, courir, croire, écrire, recevoir, rire, suivre, voir*).

Their present indicative, past participle, imperative forms, and the infinitives are listed in the vocabulary list.

Any other irregular present indicative forms, their past participles, imperative forms, and the infinitives are listed in the vocabulary list.

Impersonal verbs

Il y a to mean 'there is/are', *il y avait* to mean 'there was/were/used to be' and *il y aura* to mean 'there is going to be/are going to be/will be' are listed in the vocabulary list as multi-word phrases.

Il fait + adjective (eg, *il fait beau, il fait froid*). Any adjectives that would be used in this construction are listed in the vocabulary list.

Il + weather-related expressions (eg, *il neige, il y a du soleil*) are listed in the vocabulary list, as multi-word phrases where necessary.

Il faut + infinitive

Il est for telling the time

Modal verbs

Present indicative forms for 1st, 2nd, 3rd persons, in singular and plural of modals *devoir, pouvoir, savoir, vouloir* followed by infinitive. All inflected forms of the modals are listed in the vocabulary list.

Conditional forms in 1st, 2nd, 3rd persons, in singular only (excluding 'you' formal), of *vouloir* (*voudrais, voudrait*), as equivalent of English 'would like (to) + verb', are listed in the vocabulary list.

Reflexive use of verbs

1st, 2nd, 3rd persons in singular only.

Reflexive verb forms (eg, *se laver*) with the same meaning as a listed base verb (eg, *laver*) are not listed. Reflexive verb forms with different meanings from a listed base verb (eg, *passer, se passer*) will be listed on the same line. When reflexive verb forms with different meanings from a listed base verb are **not** listed, they will not be tested.

3.2.1.3 Adjectival phrases

Agreement for gender and number with nouns following regular patterns (of adjectives listed in the vocabulary list).

Gender

Highly frequent irregulars are listed in the vocabulary list as separate items (eg, *net/te*, *bon/ne*, *nouveau/nouvelle*, *pareil/le*, *travailleur/travailleuse*).

- Add -e
- No change with adjectives ending in mute -e
- -x → -se
- -el → -lle
- -en → -nne
- -f → -ve
- -er → -ère

Number

Irregulars *beau/x* and *nouveau/x* are listed in the vocabulary list as separate items.

- Add -s
- No change for masculine forms already ending in -s and -x
- -al → -aux for masculine

Position of adjectives in relation to the nouns they refer to: mostly after nouns, before nouns only for the defined set in the vocabulary list.

Use of regular (*plus...que/de*, *moins...que/de*, *aussi...que*) and irregular comparative structures, with the irregular adjectival forms (*meilleur(e)(s)* and *pire(s)*) listed in the vocabulary list.

3.2.1.4 Adverbial phrases

Adverbs and adverbial phrases are listed in the vocabulary list.

Position of adverbs of time, manner, frequency, place.

Use of regular (*plus...que*, *moins...que*, *aussi...que*) and irregular comparative structures, with the irregular adverbial form (*mieux*) listed in the vocabulary list.

3.2.1.5 Prepositions

À/de can be needed before a noun or a second verb following some verbs. These verb + preposition combinations are listed in the vocabulary list alongside the verb entry (eg, *finir* 'to finish', *finir de* + infinitive 'to finish + verb' and *dépendre* 'to depend', *dépendre de* 'to depend on + noun'). Where the preposition changes or adds to the meaning of the verb, English translations are listed (eg *arriver* 'to arrive', *arriver à* 'to manage to').

Appropriate use of *en/à* with proper nouns for places (eg countries, regions/states, cities).

Contraction of definite article when used with *à* and *de* to agree with the gender and number (ie, *à*, *à la*, *au*, *aux*; *de*, *de la*, *du*, *des* are listed in the vocabulary list).

De to indicate possession (eg, *le sac de Léa*).

Prepositions (*pour*, *sans*) + infinitive.

3.2.1.6 Derivational morphology (Reading only)

Derivational morphology listed here indicates that even if only the base form (eg, *rapide*) is listed in the vocabulary list, a derived form that follows one of the patterns listed here (eg, *rapidement*) may be included in reading texts – or if only the specific affixed form is listed, the base form may be

included in reading texts. Note, if derived forms are included in listening material or required for production, they are listed separately in the vocabulary list.

Uniformly applicable derivational morphology that changes meaning

Ordinal numbers created by adding *-ième* (or by dropping *-e* and adding *-ième*) to cardinal numbers eg, *deux* – *deuxième*, *quatre* – *quatrième*. Irregular forms *premier* and *première* are listed in the vocabulary list.

Other highly frequent patterns

Morphology that changes meaning

Prefixes: adding *in-* or *im-* to adjectives, adverbs and nouns, only where the English equivalent is *un-* or *in-* or means 'opposite of'. Eg, *également* → *inégalement*, *sécurité* → *insécurité*, *possible* → *impossible*.

Morphology that changes the part of speech

Suffixes:

- Adjectives created by adding *-able* or *-eable* to the verb stem, only where the English equivalent is *-able* or *-ible*. Eg, *porter* → *portable*, *changer* → *changeable*.
- Nouns created by adding *-ion* or *-ation* to the verb stem, only where the English equivalent is *-ion* or *-ation*. Eg, *progresser* → *progression*, *préparer* → *préparation*.
- Adverbs ending in *-ment*, only where the English equivalent is *-ly*, created by:
 - adding *-ment* to the feminine form of adjectives eg, *première* → *premièrement*
 - by dropping *-ant(e)/-ent(e)* from an adjective and adding *-amment/-emment* eg, *courant* → *couramment*, *patient* → *patiemment*.